

CHATGPT FOR

Career Development

Using AI to read job postings, tailor application materials, and rehearse interviews without losing your own voice.

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College of Education Practicum

Graduating seniors preparing for the job search

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“Ethical and Pedagogical Applications of AI”

Purpose of This Session

This presentation was built for graduating seniors in the College of Education practicum. The goal is not to let AI do the work for you. The goal is to use ChatGPT as a thinking partner that helps you prepare smarter, faster, and with more confidence.

WHAT WE WILL DO

Use ChatGPT in three practical moments: reading a job posting, revising application materials, and practicing interview responses.

WHY IT MATTERS

Strong candidates do not just list experiences. They show fit, mirror priorities, and speak clearly about what they bring to a school or district.

KEEP YOUR JUDGMENT

Use AI for feedback, structure, and rehearsal. Keep your actual voice, examples, and professional values at the center.

Analyze the Job Description

Start by asking ChatGPT to read the posting like a hiring committee would. This helps students spot the skills, priorities, and repeated language that matter most.

What to ask ChatGPT

- Identify the top 5 skills, qualifications, or priorities the district is emphasizing.
- List keywords or phrases I should mirror in my application materials.
- Summarize what this school is really looking for in 2 to 3 sentences.

What to look for

- Repeated words tied to instruction, classroom culture, or collaboration.
- Signals about district priorities such as equity, data use, or family engagement.
- Requirements you must address directly instead of assuming they are obvious.

How to use the response

- Turn the keywords into a checklist before editing your resume or cover letter.
- Highlight experiences that match the posting instead of sending a generic application.
- Use the summary to clarify the kind of candidate you want to sound like.

Tailor Resume and Cover Letter

Once the posting is clear, use ChatGPT to compare your current materials against the position and suggest targeted revisions.

What to ask ChatGPT

- Paste the job description first, then either upload the files or paste the resume and cover letter text into the chat.
- Ask ChatGPT to compare the materials against the position and identify 3 to 5 targeted changes.
- Request keywords from the posting that should appear more clearly in the documents.

What to look for

- Remove private details you do not need for feedback, such as full address, personal phone numbers, or student ID information.
- Do not upload anything that contains sensitive records, recommendation letters, or hidden metadata you would not want reused.
- If you are using a shared or public account, be extra cautious about what personal information you provide.

How to use the response

- Use the response to revise emphasis, organization, and wording while keeping your real experiences intact.
- Double-check every edit for accuracy and make sure the final version still sounds like you.
- If you upload a file, consider copying the revised text into a clean document instead of submitting AI output without review.

Interview Preparation Practice

ChatGPT can also simulate an interview and give immediate coaching, which is especially useful for students who need low-stakes practice before the real conversation.

What to ask ChatGPT

- Act as an interviewer for this teaching position.
- Ask me five interview questions one at a time.
- After each answer, give brief feedback and suggest one way to make it stronger.

What to look for

- Questions about classroom management, instructional planning, and collaboration.
- Feedback on whether your answer is specific, organized, and student-centered.
- Patterns in your answers that may need more evidence or reflection.

How to use the response

- Practice speaking in complete answers instead of only thinking through ideas.
- Use the feedback loop to tighten examples and improve confidence.
- Keep refining until your responses sound clear, concrete, and authentic.

Use AI as a coach, not a substitute.

Your best materials will still sound like you. ChatGPT can help you see patterns, sharpen language, and practice out loud, but it should not replace your story, your examples, or your judgment.

Thank you

Questions, examples, or live practice prompts can be added in a future workshop version.

BEST NEXT STEPS

Copy one job description into ChatGPT, run the three prompt workflows, and turn the strongest feedback into concrete edits.

GOOD GUARDRAILS

Check every claim for accuracy, remove anything that does not sound like you, and never submit materials you have not carefully reviewed.

TAKEAWAY

AI can reduce stress in the job search when you use it to prepare with intention, not to bypass the real work of reflection and communication.